meditation (*samadhi*). Buddhists insist that virtue is necessary for the cultivation of meditation and insight. In early Buddhism, intention (*cetana*) is understood as determining the moral quality of an action. Morality consists in deliberate abstention from murder, theft, sexual misconduct, false speech, slander, harsh words, frivolous talk, covetousness, malice and false views. Right livelihood would preclude such occupations as arms-trading, dealing in drugs and alcohol, and butchering animals. *Samadhi* is the achievement of tranquillity through avoidance of distractions, and by suppression of sensory activity. Emphasis is placed upon mindfulness or exercising control over one's physical, mental and emotional states. *Samadhi* also involves the cultivation of goodwill, compassion, joy and equanimity.

The path is the 'middle way' between the self-indulgent and ascetic lives, neither of which lead to release from the desire-fuelled series of existences. What is needed is the elimination of the basic defects of craving, aversion and delusion. Buddhism claims to be a true universal morality. Its ethical principles are 'don't kill, don't steal, don't tell lies, avoid intoxicants and sexual misdemeanours'. It differs from ***caste***-based Hinduism where what is morally right for a person depends upon their ***caste*** status.

Further reading: Conze 1959; Keown 1992; Siderits 2003

Number see ***Samkhya***

Nyaya: one of the six orthodox Brahminical schools (***darshana***). Nyaya accepted the ***Vaisheshika*** categorisation (***padartha***) of reality and was chiefly concerned with questions of logic and how we can know anything. Major works and theorists include *Gautama Akshapada* (c. 150 CE), the author of the fundamental *Nyaya-Sutra*;